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F1 ABU DHABI GRAND PRIX CONFIRMED: 'WE WILL DELIVER CALENDAR AS PROMISED'

Final race of the season at Yas Marina Circuit to be held on December 3-6

DUBAI
BY CHRISTIAN BORRON
Senior Web Editor

Formula One has confirmed that the Abu Dhabi Grand Prix will go ahead as the final race of the 2026 season at Yas Marina Circuit from December 3 to 6.

Formula One President and CEO Stefano Domenicali said the calendar remains unchanged, with preparations for the season finale nearing completion.

"The calendar is confirmed. There are still a few tickets to be sold in Abu Dhabi... and we stay focused on delivering the calendar we promised at the beginning of the year," Domenicali said.

Progressing well

He added that preparations for the December 3-6 event were progressing well, with some tickets still available.

The confirmation comes as



Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

■ The Formula 1 Etihad Airways Abu Dhabi Grand Prix will go ahead as scheduled at the Yas Marina Circuit, Formula 1 President and CEO, Stefano Domenicali confirmed yesterday.

fans plan travel and accommodation for the final race of the 2026 Formula One calendar.

Saood Abdulaziz Al Hosani, Undersecretary of the Department of Culture and Tourism –

Abu Dhabi, said the emirate has hosted Formula One since 2009 and that the race has created opportunities for its tourism, hospitality and events sectors.

"We look forward to wel-

coming international F1 fans once again for the conclusion of a thrilling season," he said.

Saif Rashid Al Noaimi, CEO of Ethara, which promotes the Abu Dhabi Grand Prix, said

The calendar is confirmed. There are still a few tickets to be sold in Abu Dhabi... and we stay focused on delivering the calendar we promised at the beginning of the year."

Stefano Domenicali
Formula One President and CEO

preparations were continuing for the December event.

The race weekend will include Formula One action at Yas Marina Circuit, alongside concerts and other entertainment and hospitality events across Yas Island. Ticket availability is now limited, with organisers advising fans to check remaining options ahead of the season finale.

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DXB gears up for 3.7m passengers in return rush

DUBAI
Gulf News Report

Dubai International Airport is preparing to handle about 3.7 million passengers during a peak travel period as residents return from summer holidays.

Majed Al Joker, Chief Operating Officer at Dubai Airports, told *Emarat Al Youm* that average daily passenger traffic is expected to reach about 222,000, with transit travellers accounting for roughly 46 per cent of the total during the period, according to the newspaper.

Al Joker said teams at Dubai International, or DXB, are working around the clock to manage the increase in passenger numbers and maintain operational efficiency.

Preparations cover the passenger journey from arrivals and baggage reclaim to ground transport areas, while teams are also ready to respond to any operational changes that may arise.

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80% of Hormuz tankers go 'dark'

Hidden flows keep crude moving, holding oil prices in check

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N.R.
Senior Associate Editor

More than 80 per cent of tanker traffic moving through the Strait of Hormuz is now going "dark", creating a largely invisible oil corridor that is helping crude continue to flow despite the crisis – and limiting pressure on global prices.

Tankers are increasingly switching off or manipulating their Automatic Identification System (AIS) signals as they navigate the strategic waterway, making their movements difficult to track through conventional shipping data.

The practice is reminiscent of the tactics long used by Iran's so-called "dark fleet" to move sanctioned oil while avoiding detection.

Similar techniques

Now, amid the US-Iran confrontation and restrictions around Hormuz, similar techniques are helping vessels navigate one of the world's most important energy chokepoints. According to Kpler, more than 80 per cent of vessels currently transiting Hormuz are not appearing normally on tracking systems.

That means publicly visible shipping traffic dramatically understates the amount of oil actually passing through the

IRAN FEELS STRAIN

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian has acknowledged that the country is grappling with "many problems" as a fresh US sanctions campaign piles further pressure on an economy already strained by nearly six months of war.

strait. The hidden flows help explain why crude prices have not surged as dramatically as might be expected from a prolonged disruption to a waterway that normally carries about a fifth of global petroleum liquids consumption.

Instead of a complete shutdown, an opaque system of tanker movements has emerged, allowing some energy exporters to continue while shipowners attempt to reduce their exposure to attacks, interception or other security risks.

The development also complicates efforts to assess the true impact of the crisis. Satellite tracking and port data can eventually reveal some movements, but real-time visibility has become increasingly unreliable.

For oil markets, however, what matters most is that barrels are still moving. As long as substantial volumes continue slipping through Hormuz – visible or otherwise – the "dark" tanker route could provide an unexpected cushion against the price shock feared when the crisis began.

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